

CPO / Head of Product — BAUF Profile

Role Mission

Build and lead BAUF's product function as a structured, scalable and data-driven product system: product strategy, portfolio management, R&D, product analytics, PIM, ERP product data, certification, artworks, technical and marketing materials, and full product readiness for Sales, Supply, Marketing and Service.

Core Responsibilities

Area	Expectations
Product Strategy & Portfolio	Build and manage BAUF's product portfolio, starting with the most strategic categories, especially CLIMATE. Define product architecture, model roles, positioning, lifecycle logic, phase-in / phase-out rules and category priorities.
Product Team Management	Build, organize and manage the product team. Define roles, responsibilities, workflows, deadlines, quality standards and cooperation rules inside the product department and with other departments.
Market & Product Analytics	Implement a structured product analysis system based on BAUF's Product Analysis Models: Product Benchmark Database, Competitive Benchmarking, Weighted Product Score, Value Index, Specification Gap Analysis, Portfolio Positioning Matrix, Market Standard Check, Price-Performance Map, Price Waterfall and Practical Output.
Product Development / R&D	Lead product development with OEM/ODM partners, mainly in China. Translate market needs, distributor feedback and installer requirements into product specifications, technical requirements and improvement requests to factories.
PIM System	Set up and manage the PIM system as the single source of truth for product data: specifications, descriptions, images, certificates, manuals, translations, product assets and product content readiness.
ERP Product Data	Organize and control the product part of ERP: SKU structure, product cards, categories, specifications, model codes, product statuses, pricing logic and data consistency across Sales, Supply, Finance and Service.
Artwork & Packaging Control	Organize and control the preparation of all product artworks: packaging, stickers, labels, nameplates, manuals, cartons and related product markings. Ensure artwork preparation is error-free, properly checked and clearly coordinated between Product, Marketing, Supply, factories and other involved teams.

Area	Expectations
Technical & Marketing Materials	Ensure that every product has a complete and accurate material package: datasheets, manuals, installation guides, service documents, catalogues, brochures, website content, sales presentations, dealer materials and training materials.
Certification & Regulation	Coordinate product certification and regulatory compliance, especially for European markets: CE, energy labels, ErP, F-gas, declarations, safety documentation, local language requirements and other product-related regulatory obligations.
New Product Introduction (NPI)	Own the product launch readiness process: specs approval, product data, ERP/PIM readiness, certification, artworks, documentation, sales materials, training package and final handover to Sales, Marketing, Supply and Service.
Cross-functional Coordination	Build clear cooperation between Product, Supply, Sales, Marketing and Service so that product decisions, product data, materials, launch plans and market feedback are managed in one structured process.

Required Experience

- 8+ years in product / category / portfolio management.
- Strong experience in **HVAC / climate equipment** - strong advantage.
- Proven experience managing a **product team**, not only individual products.
- Experience building product processes, workflows and reporting systems.
- Experience with **OEM/ODM manufacturers**, ideally Chinese factories.
- Experience launching and managing physical product lines.
- Understanding of European product requirements, certification and technical documentation.
- Strong experience with **PIM / ERP / PLM / product databases / BI tools**.
- Experience managing product content, artworks, packaging, manuals and technical materials.
- Experience working cross-functionally with Sales, Supply, Marketing and Service.

Key Skills

- Strong managerial ability: team leadership, prioritization, task decomposition, control of deadlines and quality.
- Strong system thinking: ability to build product processes, not just manage separate product tasks.
- Advanced hard skills in modern IT systems, product data management, analytics tools and structured databases.

- Strong analytical toolkit: benchmarking, scoring, value index, price-performance analysis, specification gap analysis, price waterfall.
 - Solid understanding of HVAC products: AC, heat pumps, indoor/outdoor units, efficiency, installation logic, energy labels.
 - Ability to convert market feedback into clear product and factory requirements.
 - High attention to detail in specifications, product data, certification, documentation and artworks.
 - Strong project management across multiple teams, countries and factories.
 - Ability to work between European market requirements and Chinese manufacturing reality.
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Nice to Have

- Experience in B2B distributor / installer-driven business model.
 - Experience building a product department from scratch.
 - Experience with multi-country product portfolios.
 - Russian language - strong advantage.
 - English - mandatory working level (B2).
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Short Profile Summary

BAUF needs a CPO who is both a strong product leader and a strong system builder: someone able to manage the product team, build clear processes, use modern IT and analytics tools, and own the full product cycle from market analysis and R&D to PIM, ERP, certification, artworks, materials and launch readiness.